

Zero to One — Revision Booklet

Peter Thiel • 2-page rapid revision • Concepts → Mental model → Recall questions

30-second mental model: Read the bold chain below, then try to explain the book without looking at the page.

Secret → 0→1 → Narrow Market → Monopoly/Moat → Scale

CORE CONCEPTS

- 0→1 = creating something genuinely new; 1→N = copying/scaling.
- Seek secrets: valuable truths that few people recognize.
- Start with a small, specific market you can dominate.
- Monopoly through differentiation is preferable to endless commodity competition.
- Durable moats can come from technology, network effects, scale, brand/distribution.

CORE CONCEPTS — CONTINUED

- Distribution matters as much as product quality.
- Ask: What valuable company is nobody building?
- Build a beachhead, dominate it, then expand.
- Think about the future as something you can create, not merely extrapolate.

Zero to One — Active Recall

Close the book. Answer these from memory. Then revisit only the concepts you missed.

1. What is my 0→1 insight?

2. What narrow market could I dominate first?

3. What makes my advantage difficult to copy?

One-sentence teach-back: Explain the entire book to someone in one sentence.

Top 3 ideas I will apply: 1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____

Next review: _____ Score: ____ / 10